Apex Systems

Response to Request for Proposal

RFP-2026-017: Enterprise Vendor Management and Spend Analytics Platform (500 users, SAP S/4HANA + Oracle Fusion Finance + Okta SSO integration)

Submitted by: Apex Systems (fictional supplier for classroom use)
Validity of offer: 90 days from submission.

Company Profile

Apex Systems is an enterprise software vendor headquartered in Frankfurt with 650 employees and a focus on regulated industries such as banking and manufacturing. Its engineering organisation owns the entire product stack, and the company invests heavily in security assurance and platform reliability.

1. Executive Summary

Apex Systems understands that the procurement organisation needs a single platform to manage vendor onboarding, contracts, performance and spend analytics for 500 users across four regions. We propose our Apex VendorCore platform, a cloud-native product that is already in production at large manufacturers and banks.

Our proposal emphasises engineering depth, security assurance and long-term scalability. We are not the cheapest bidder; our price reflects a premium architecture and a full compliance programme.

2. Proposed Solution and Technical Architecture

VendorCore is built as a set of microservices on Kubernetes with REST and GraphQL APIs. The platform auto-scales horizontally and was load tested at 5,000 concurrent users, ten times the requirement. Multi-region active-passive deployment provides disaster recovery with a 15-minute RPO and 1-hour RTO; contractual uptime SLA is 99.95%.

Integration: we provide a SAP-certified S/4HANA connector, an Oracle Fusion Finance adapter delivered through Oracle Integration Cloud, and SSO through SAML 2.0 and OIDC with Okta. Event streaming (Kafka) supports near-real-time spend synchronisation. An architecture diagram and integration specification are included in Appendix A.

3. Implementation Approach, Timeline and Team

Delivery follows five phases over 9 months: Discovery (weeks 1-4), Design (5-10), Build and Integrate (11-26), UAT and Hardening (27-33), Go-live and Hypercare (34-39). The core team has 12 named roles including a project manager, solution architect, two integration engineers and a security lead.

A risk register is maintained weekly; top risks are ERP data quality and SSO policy changes, mitigated through early data profiling. The schedule is longer than some competitors because we complete full penetration testing before go-live.

4. Price Table (3-year, USD)

Item	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Platform licence (500 users)	420,000	420,000	420,000
Implementation services	310,000	-	-
Integration (SAP, Oracle, Okta)	120,000	-	-
Premium support	60,000	60,000	60,000
Total 3-year cost	910,000	480,000	480,000

Assumptions: fixed price for implementation; licence fees indexed at 3% after year 1; travel at cost; data migration of up to 5 million records included. Grand total: USD 1,870,000.

5. Security, Compliance and Risk Controls

Apex holds ISO 27001 and SOC 2 Type II certifications, audited annually. Data is encrypted with AES-256 at rest and TLS 1.3 in transit, with field-level encryption for bank details. Role-based access control and mandatory MFA are enforced; all administrative actions are written to immutable audit logs retained for 7 years and streamed to the customer's SIEM.

A third-party penetration test is performed twice a year and results are shared under NDA. We sign a GDPR data processing agreement and support EU data residency.

6. Support Model, Experience and References

Standard support is business hours (8x5) with a 4-hour P1 response; 24x7 premium support is priced in the table above. We have delivered 6 similar vendor-management deployments in the last four years.

References: a European automotive group (8,000 users) and a regional bank (2,500 users); contact details provided on request.